Silsila – Software Requirements Document (SRD)

2026-09-19

1. Introduction

1.1 Project Overview

Silsila is a web-based Islamic Jurisprudence (Fiqh) platform for Sharia students and researchers, focused on the fiqh of nikah (marriage) and talaq (divorce). Its aim is to let a student trace one ruling's full chain of reasoning — from the Qur'anic verse to the modern law, if one exists — without cross-referencing five separate books.

During the development of this idea, two recurring problems were identified in how nikah/talaq fiqh is typically studied:

1. The fragmentation problem. The ayah, its tafsir, the supporting hadith, each madhab's opinion, and the corresponding modern statute each live in a different book or source. A student who wants to trace one ruling end-to-end has to manually assemble it themselves, and it is easy to lose or misattribute a source along the way.

2. The comparison problem. Most fiqh texts state that scholars disagree on an issue but rarely present each madhab's position side by side with its evidence, so students memorize that there is a khilaf without easily seeing why.

Silsila addresses these by linking each ayah to its adopted tafsir, its hadith al-ahkam, the mas'ala it raises, each madhab's position on that mas'ala (displayed side by side), and the equivalent qanun where one exists — every link carrying a citation back to its source.

1.2 Purpose of this Document

This SRD describes what Silsila should do and the quality standards it should meet, for the course supervisor, the development effort, and the domain expert (faqih) who reviews the fiqh content. It serves as the reference for design and testing.

1.3 Scope

The first release of Silsila is a Minimum Viable Product (MVP), scoped to the fiqh of nikah and talaq only. It covers: viewing the ayah → tafsir → hadith → mas'ala → khilaf → qanun chain for a bounded set of nikah/talaq issues; searching and browsing those issues; and a curation dashboard where a contributor proposes links and a reviewer (faqih/professor) approves them before publishing.

Out of scope for this phase: fiqh chapters outside nikah/talaq, user accounts/bookmarks, and AI-assisted link suggestion (noted as future work).

1.4 Requirements Elicitation

We held an informal, non-official discussion with a PhD student specializing in Shariah, who provided guidance on how to approach identifying and structuring this project's requirements — including how nikah and talaq fiqh issues are typically organized, and what a useful comparison of madhab opinions should

contain. This informal consultation shaped the initial functional requirements in Section 2. A formal, structured interview with the course's fiqh professor is planned next, using the requirements questionnaire prepared for that purpose, to validate and refine these requirements before final submission.

2. Functional Requirements

The system shall provide the following functions.

ID	Requirement	Description	Priority
FR-1	Chain View	The system shall display, for a selected ayah, its full chain: adopted tafsir, hadith al-ahkam, mas'ala, and qanun (if any).	High
FR-2	Madhab Comparison	The system shall display each madhab's (Hanafi, Maliki, Shafi'i, Hanbali) position on a given mas'ala side by side, with each position's evidence/reference.	High
FR-3	Fiqh Issue Search	The system shall allow users to search for a nikah/talaq mas'ala using free text, matching against issue titles and keywords.	High
FR-4	Hierarchical Navigation	The system shall allow browsing issues in the order Book (Nikah/Talaq) > Chapter (e.g., conditions of a valid contract, types of talaq) > Issue.	Medium
FR-5	Source Citation Display	Every tafsir, hadith, madhab position, and qanun entry shall display its citation (book, hadith number, or statute reference).	High
FR-6	Curation Dashboard	The system shall provide a dashboard where a contributor can propose a link and a reviewer can approve or reject it before it is published.	High
FR-7	Reviewer Login	The system shall require a reviewer/admin to log in with a username and password before accessing the curation dashboard.	Medium

3. Non-Functional Requirements

ID	Category	Requirement
NFR-1	Performance	The system shall return search results in under 2 seconds for at least 95% of queries under normal load.
NFR-2	Usability	The system shall use a responsive design across mobile, tablet, and laptop, and shall fully support Arabic text with right-to-left (RTL) layout.
NFR-3	Security	Reviewer/admin passwords shall be stored in hashed form, and only authenticated reviewers may approve, edit, or publish content.
NFR-4	Data Integrity	No link (ayah–hadith, mas'ala–madhab position, mas'ala–qanun) shall be publishable without a non-empty citation field.

4. Traceability Matrix

Each functional requirement is linked to at least one use case, so that every requirement can be followed into design and testing. Actors: Student (UC-1, UC-2, UC-3), Contributor (UC-4), Reviewer (UC-5, UC-6).

Requirement	UC-1	UC-2	UC-3	UC-4	UC-5	UC-6
FR-1 Chain View		✓				
FR-2 Madhab Comparison		✓				
FR-3 Fiqh Issue Search	✓					
FR-4 Hierarchical Navigation			✓			
FR-5 Source Citation		✓				
FR-6 Curation Dashboard				✓	✓	
FR-7 Reviewer Login						✓

Use case legend:

UC-1: Search Issue — a student searches for a nikah/talaq mas'ala.

UC-2: View Chain & Compare — a student views the ayah's full chain and compares madhab positions.

UC-3: Browse Categories — a student browses issues by book/chapter.

UC-4: Propose Link — a contributor proposes a new link between entities.

UC-5: Review & Approve — a reviewer approves or rejects a proposed link.

UC-6: Reviewer Login — a reviewer authenticates before accessing the dashboard.

5. Glossary

Term	Definition
SRD	Software Requirements Document — describes what a system must do and the quality standards it must meet.
Ayah	A verse of the Qur'an.
Tafsir	The scholarly explanation/interpretation of an ayah's meaning.
Hadith al-ahkam	A hadith that establishes or clarifies a legal ruling.
Mas'ala	A specific fiqh (jurisprudential) issue or question.
Madhab	A school of Islamic jurisprudence (e.g., Hanafi, Maliki, Shafi'i, Hanbali).
Khilaf	Scholarly disagreement between madhahib on a mas'ala.
Qanun	Modern codified/statutory law.
MVP	Minimum Viable Product — the first version including only core features.
Fiqh	Islamic Jurisprudence; the study of practical rulings in Islam.